

Thin PCs: Need of the hour

We talk about the latest PC trends that are emerging at the workspace, and how they are making a lot of sense

Mxit Interview

We chat up with the founders of this new messaging app and try to decode its mantra

FUTURE TECH CAREERS

We try gazing into the crystal ball to tell you about interesting career options that you need to prepare for right now. The future is going to be increasingly digital, and techies will be in huge demand, more than ever.

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Gone are the days of cliché jobs like doctors, engineers and lawyers, which was the pool of career choices your parents wanted you to select from. Technology has expanded like never before in the past few years and the speed is only increasing at a scorching pace. This advancement in technology will undoubtedly spawn never-thought-of-before tech careers. Take a look at some tech careers that are bound to become hot picks in the near future. Some have already arrived.

Chief Digital Officer

A Chief Digital Officer (CDO) is a job profile that has sprung up in the last few years and is already making serious inroads into the corporate world. What's more, it's also stated to be the fastest path to becoming the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of a company. And if you thought that this job profile isn't in the limelight, then think again; the

State of New York, Harvard University and the Metropolitan Museum of Art all have their own CDOs.

The role of a CDO is ever-expanding, but the main focus of the job is to convert the analogue processes/components of a company into digital processes. This is done to increase their accessibility and to make more sense of a mountain of data. Basically, the CDO is responsible for the digital customer experience of the company wherever it may apply in a business. Your work profile may however depend on the company you're working for; E.g. the role of the CDO of the Metropolitan Museum of

Art, at the time of joining, involved leading the digital media department's initiatives related to creation of documentation and interpretive material on the museum's collection. So you can say that a CDO is someone who, keeping the marketing and experience perspective in mind, is responsible for the IT implementation of an initiative. S/he won't be concerned with the technical aspects of the implementation but will

be concerned with what information is put across, how it is put across, how it is used, the delivery mode used and all semantics related to the experience of the consumer of the digital data.

To become a CDO, you must possess a good understanding of Marketing along with the capabilities of different technologies. The CDO acts as a bridge between the Marketing department and the IT department.

Artificial Intelligence Programmer

Face it, many of us geeks daydream about the ultimate Artificial Intelligence (AI) personality (Commander Data of *Star Trek*, anyone?) as much as we dream about ET contact. Keeping Hollywood doomsday scenarios aside (*Skynet*), AI is set to rule the future world for the good of mankind. In areas where a myriad of critical intelligent decisions are required, we can no longer depend on simple computer programs that follow a set of rules to take decisions. We need software that can think and take decisions. So, if you're thinking about a career in AI Programming then you may just be on the path to becoming a hot commodity in the market. The applications of AI Programming are many, to name a few: Entertainment, Safety, Military Operations (The human race is intelligent

